

United States History and Geography — Teacher Key

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form FORM-A

TEACHER COPY — contains answer keys and rationales. Not for student distribution.

classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument.

1. Use the political cartoon to answer the question. The cartoon, published in Harper's Weekly in 1874 by Thomas Nast, shows a White League member and a Ku Klux Klan member shaking hands over a crouching African American family. A lynched body hangs in the background, a burning schoolhouse is visible, and the caption reads 'The Union as It Was' with 'Worse Than Slavery' at the bottom. What does the handshake between the White League member and the Ku Klux Klan member most directly represent?

- A. A rivalry between two competing groups for political control of Southern states
- B. A political compromise to end military occupation of the South
- C. An alliance between white supremacist groups using violence to oppress Black citizens
- D. An agreement between Southern leaders to support federal Reconstruction policies

KEY: C · DOK 1 · US.04, US.05

Why the key is right: C is correct: The handshake represents cooperation between two white supremacist organizations that used terror to undermine Reconstruction and oppress African Americans. A is incorrect: the cartoon depicts opposition to Reconstruction, not support for a compromise policy. B is incorrect: there is no reference to federal legislation being passed in the image. D is incorrect: the cartoon does not portray these groups as rivals but as allies working toward the same oppressive goal.

2. Use the political cartoon to answer the question. The cartoon, published in Harper's Weekly in 1874 by Thomas Nast, shows a White League member and a Ku Klux Klan member shaking hands over a crouching African American family, with a lynched body and burning schoolhouse visible. The caption reads 'Worse Than Slavery.' Nast's caption 'Worse Than Slavery' suggests which of the following arguments about Reconstruction?

- A. Legal freedom without federal protection left African Americans vulnerable to violence and oppression comparable to enslavement
- B. Free labor was economically less productive than enslaved labor in the postwar South
- C. Southern states had achieved greater independence after Reconstruction than before the Civil War
- D. Many formerly enslaved people preferred the security of slavery over the uncertainties of freedom

KEY: A · DOK 2 · US.04, US.05

Why the key is right: A is correct: Nast argues that the terror and violence of the post-Reconstruction South—mob lynching, burning of schools, and organized white supremacist groups—created conditions as bad as or worse than enslavement for Black Americans, since legal freedom offered little protection without federal enforcement. B is incorrect: the cartoon criticizes the failure of Reconstruction, not enslaved people's preferences. C is incorrect: the cartoon does not address economic arguments about free vs. enslaved labor. D is incorrect: Nast's message is a critique of the abandonment of Black Southerners, not a celebration of Southern independence.

3. Use the political cartoon to answer the question. The cartoon, published in Harper's Weekly in 1874 by Thomas Nast, shows a White League member and a Ku Klux Klan member shaking hands over a crouching African American family. A burning schoolhouse and lynched body appear in the background. The caption reads 'Worse Than Slavery.' Which broader historical development best explains the conditions Nast depicts in this cartoon?

- A. The success of Congressional Reconstruction in rebuilding Southern state governments
- B. The collapse of federal enforcement in the South, allowing white supremacist groups to reverse Reconstruction gains
- C. The passage of the 13th Amendment, which immediately guaranteed equal rights for all citizens
- D. The spread of the sharecropping system, which kept formerly enslaved people in economic dependency

KEY: B · DOK 3 · US.04, US.05

Why the key is right: D is correct: After federal troops began withdrawing and Republican governments lost power in the South (Redemption), white supremacist paramilitary groups like the KKK and White League used systematic violence and intimidation to strip African Americans of their political and civil rights, effectively ending Reconstruction's promises. A is incorrect: the 13th Amendment abolished slavery but could not by itself prevent the violence depicted. B is incorrect: sharecropping was an economic system; while oppressive, it is not the direct cause of the organized terror shown. C is incorrect: the cartoon depicts the failure of Congressional Reconstruction, not its successes.

4. Look at the word assimilation. It means to make people fit into a new culture. The Dawes Act tried to make Native Americans do what?

- A. Form their own separate country
- B. Leave the United States
- C. Return to their original lands
- D. Give up their traditions and live like white settlers

KEY: D · DOK 1 · US.05

Why the key is right: The Dawes Act (1887) was designed to force Native Americans to assimilate into white American culture by breaking up tribal land and assigning individual plots. Focus: the GOAL of assimilation.

5. The Dawes Act of 1887 was primarily designed to:

- A. Provide military protection for American Indian communities
- B. Divide tribal lands into individual allotments to promote private land ownership
- C. Create boarding schools for American Indian children
- D. Establish permanent reservation boundaries for American Indian tribes to prevent further land disputes

KEY: B · DOK 1 · US.05

Why the key is right: Requires recall of a specific fact, term, or event — no analysis required.

6. Which statement best describes the federal government's assimilation policy toward American Indians in the late 19th century?

- A. The government sought to preserve traditional American Indian languages and cultural practices on reservations
- B. The government promoted cultural exchange between American Indians
- C. The government aimed to eliminate American Indian cultural practices
- D. The government focused exclusively on military conquest without attempting cultural change

KEY: C · DOK 2 · US.05

Why the key is right: Requires understanding of cause, effect, or concept — beyond simple recall.

7. Use the political cartoon to answer the question. The cartoon from Puck magazine shows Theodore Roosevelt wielding a large club labeled 'Big Stick' against moneybag figures representing industrial trusts, depicting his Progressive Era antitrust policies. What does the 'Big Stick' label on Roosevelt's club most directly symbolize?

- A. The labor union movement that supported Roosevelt's antitrust agenda
- B. Presidential and federal power used to confront and regulate corporate monopolies
- C. The U.S. military, which Roosevelt deployed against striking workers
- D. Public outrage that pressured Congress to pass antitrust legislation

KEY: B · DOK 1 · US.06, US.15

Why the key is right: C is correct: The 'Big Stick' refers to Roosevelt's foreign and domestic policy philosophy — 'speak softly and carry a big stick' — representing the use of executive power and government authority to confront and control powerful interests, in this context the industrial trusts. A is incorrect: the military was not the primary tool Roosevelt used against domestic trusts; he used legal and regulatory action. B is incorrect: the Big Stick represents federal power, not support for labor unions specifically. D is incorrect: the cartoon depicts Roosevelt using the stick against corporations, not as a symbol of public opinion.

8. Use the political cartoon to answer the question. The Puck magazine cartoon shows Theodore Roosevelt swinging a club labeled 'Big Stick' at moneybag figures representing industrial trusts during the Progressive Era. Roosevelt's campaign against industrial trusts is best understood as a response to which of the following conditions?

- A. European nations forming economic alliances that threatened American trade dominance
- B. Massive industrial monopolies that had accumulated enough power to undermine competition and corrupt government
- C. A wave of immigration that disrupted American labor markets and industry
- D. Small businesses calling on the federal government to protect them from foreign competitors

KEY: B · DOK 2 · US.06, US.15

Why the key is right: D is correct: During the Gilded Age, massive industrial monopolies like Standard Oil, U.S. Steel, and railroad trusts had accumulated so much market power that they could fix prices, eliminate competition, and corrupt government. Roosevelt's trust-busting responded specifically to this concentration of economic power, using the Sherman Antitrust Act to break up some combinations deemed harmful to competition. A is incorrect: the cartoon depicts Roosevelt confronting trusts, not protecting them. B is incorrect: immigration and labor reform were separate Progressive Era issues not depicted here. C is incorrect: foreign policy rivalry is not the focus of this cartoon or Roosevelt's domestic trust policy.

9. Use the political cartoon to answer the question. The Puck magazine cartoon shows Theodore Roosevelt wielding his 'Big Stick' against industrial trusts, portraying him as a forceful reformer challenging the economic power of corporate monopolies. Historians debate whether Roosevelt was a genuine opponent of big business or a moderate who actually preserved corporate capitalism. Which evidence from your knowledge of his presidency best supports the argument that Roosevelt's trust-busting was selective and limited?

- A. Roosevelt refused to pursue any antitrust cases, preferring instead to negotiate privately with corporate leaders
- B. Roosevelt's antitrust campaign quickly lost public support because most Americans opposed government regulation of business
- C. Roosevelt distinguished between 'good trusts' and 'bad trusts,' targeting only those he deemed harmful while leaving many large corporations intact
- D. Congress blocked all of Roosevelt's antitrust legislation, and courts struck down the Sherman Antitrust Act during his presidency

KEY: C · DOK 3 · US.06, US.15

Why the key is right: B is correct: Roosevelt himself distinguished between 'good trusts' (large, efficient corporations that he believed served the public) and 'bad trusts' (those that abused their power). He pursued only 44 antitrust cases during his presidency and allowed many large corporations to continue operating, suggesting his trust-busting was strategic and selective, not a wholesale attack on big business. A is incorrect: the cartoon depicts Roosevelt actively challenging trusts, not ignoring them. C is incorrect: Roosevelt's progressive reforms were politically popular; claiming he lost public support is inaccurate. D is incorrect: Congress, not the courts, created the Sherman Antitrust Act; and the courts did limit some antitrust actions, but this does not explain Roosevelt's own limited approach.

10. Sinclair's novel, from which this passage is taken, contributed most directly to the passage of which federal legislation?

- A.** The Sherman Antitrust Act
- B.** The Pure Food and Drug Act and Meat Inspection Act
- C.** The Federal Reserve Act
- D.** The Underwood Tariff Act

KEY: B · DOK 2 · US.15

Why the key is right: Upton Sinclair's *The Jungle* (1906) exposed filthy conditions in Chicago's meatpacking plants, and public outrage over the food supply pushed Congress to pass the Pure Food and Drug Act and the Meat Inspection Act that same year. Choice A is wrong because the Sherman Antitrust Act dated from 1890 and concerned monopoly, not food safety. Choice B is wrong because the Federal Reserve Act of 1913 dealt with banking. Sinclair aimed at the exploitation of workers and later observed that he had aimed at the public's heart and hit its stomach.

11. How did Booker T. Washington's approach to African American advancement differ from W.E.B. Du Bois's approach in the early 1900s?

- A.** Washington worked with the Republican Party to pass federal civil rights legislation while Du Bois organized strikes by Black industrial workers
- B.** Washington focused on political protest and legal challenges to Jim Crow laws while Du Bois emphasized Black economic development through business ownership
- C.** Washington emphasized vocational training and economic self-reliance while accepting temporary social segregation, whereas Du Bois demanded immediate civil and political equality
- D.** Washington supported Black emigration to Africa as the only path to equality while Du Bois argued for integration within American society

KEY: C · DOK 2 · US.15

Why the key is right: Washington's Atlanta Compromise (1895) accepted segregation in exchange for white support of Black vocational education and economic development. Du Bois rejected this, arguing in *The Souls of Black Folk* that only immediate agitation for full civil rights would end Black subjugation.

12. How did W.E.B. Du Bois's founding of the Niagara Movement in 1905 reflect his disagreement with Booker T. Washington's philosophy?

- A.** The Niagara Movement focused on building Black vocational schools in the South to compete directly with Washington's Tuskegee Institute
- B.** The Niagara Movement demanded immediate political rights, civil equality, and an end to racial discrimination — rejecting Washington's policy of accommodation
- C.** The Niagara Movement supported Washington's economic self-reliance strategy but demanded that the federal government fund Black businesses
- D.** The Niagara Movement called for African Americans to emigrate to West Africa to establish an independent Black nation

KEY: B · DOK 2 · US.15

Why the key is right: The Niagara Movement's declaration demanded every civil right afforded to other Americans — voting, civil equality, and freedom of speech — directly rejecting Washington's Atlanta Compromise strategy of trading political rights for economic opportunity, and laying groundwork for the NAACP (1909).

13. Which constitutional principle did the Supreme Court establish in *Schenck v. United States*?

- A.** The federal government cannot draft citizens during wartime
- B.** All political speech is absolutely protected from federal regulation
- C.** Speech protected by the First Amendment can be limited when it creates a clear and present danger
- D.** States may not regulate any form of speech without congressional approval

KEY: C · DOK 2 · US.26

Why the key is right: In *Schenck v. United States* (1919) the Supreme Court upheld an Espionage Act conviction and held that speech loses First Amendment protection when the words create a clear and present danger of harms Congress may prevent. Choice B is wrong because the ruling established the opposite: political speech is not absolutely protected. Choice A is wrong because the constitutionality of the draft was settled in a separate line of cases. The standard governed free-speech law until it was narrowed in *Brandenburg v. Ohio* in 1969.

14. How did Germany's use of unrestricted submarine warfare help shift American public opinion toward entering World War I?

- A.** German submarines attacked ships carrying American passengers and goods, resulting in American deaths that outraged the public
- B.** German submarines were used to deliver secret agents to American ports, threatening domestic security
- C.** German submarines destroyed a US Navy warship in the Atlantic, which constituted a formal act of war under international law
- D.** German submarines blocked American ships from trading with neutral nations, causing an economic recession

KEY: A · DOK 2 · US.26

Why the key is right: The sinking of civilian ships including the *Lusitania* (1915), killing 1,198 people including 128 Americans, and Germany's resumption of unrestricted submarine warfare in 1917 turned American public opinion by making the German threat viscerally personal.

15. What was the significance of the Zimmermann Telegram in drawing the United States closer to entering World War I?

- A.** It confirmed that Britain had been secretly selling weapons to Germany, undermining US neutrality
- B.** It showed that President Wilson had been secretly negotiating a separate peace with the German government
- C.** It revealed that Germany had offered military support to Mexico in exchange for attacking the United States, alarming American leaders
- D.** It exposed a German plot to bribe US senators into blocking a declaration of war

KEY: C · DOK 2 · US.26

Why the key is right: The Zimmermann Telegram, intercepted by British intelligence in January 1917, proposed a German-Mexican alliance against the US in exchange for Mexico regaining Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona — a direct threat to American security that inflamed public and congressional opinion.

16. Which combination of factors best explains why the United States entered World War I in April 1917 rather than in 1914 when the war began?

- A.** Wilson's re-election in 1916 on a neutrality platform, combined with escalating German provocations and the Zimmermann Telegram in early 1917, tipped the balance toward war
- B.** Germany only began using submarines in 1917, and the Zimmermann Telegram was not sent until that year
- C.** Congress passed a law in 1916 requiring a two-year waiting period before any war declaration could take effect
- D.** American public opinion immediately favored war in 1914 but Congress refused to act until European allies formally requested US assistance

KEY: A · DOK 2 · US.26

Why the key is right: The US delayed entry due to genuine public preference for neutrality, Wilson's 1916 re-election slogan 'He kept us out of war,' and the absence of a clear casus belli until early 1917 brought Germany's resumption of unrestricted submarine warfare and the Zimmermann Telegram in quick succession.

17. Which conclusion about the causes of the Great Depression is best supported by evidence that American agricultural prices had been declining throughout the 1920s?

- A. The collapse of farm prices was primarily caused by tariff policies that made American agricultural exports uncompetitive in foreign markets.
- B. Economic problems that ultimately contributed to the Depression were present in the agricultural sector well before the 1929 stock market crash.
- C. Agricultural decline proved that the federal government's failure to regulate farming practices was the central long-term cause of the Depression.
- D. The international competition created by postwar European agricultural recovery was the primary driver of American farm price decline.

KEY: B · DOK 3 · US.26

Why the key is right: Rural America experienced Depression-like conditions throughout the 1920s while urban prosperity dominated headlines. This demonstrates that the Depression's roots preceded 1929 and that the crash exposed structural economic weaknesses already present.

18. Germany implemented a policy of unrestricted submarine warfare in 1917, announcing it would sink all ships — neutral or belligerent — in the war zone around Britain. Which of the following best evaluates Germany's strategic reasoning and its fatal flaw?

- A. Germany gambled that submarines could force Britain to surrender before U.S. forces mobilized — an internally coherent strategy whose fatal flaw was underestimating how quickly American troops would arrive and affect the battlefield.
- B. Germany implemented unrestricted submarine warfare with the genuine belief that the United States would never declare war regardless of the naval provocation, since domestic isolationism would prevent Wilson from taking military action.
- C. Germany implemented unrestricted submarine warfare and it succeeded strategically in forcing Britain to begin serious peace negotiations before the United States had time to formally declare war and begin mobilizing forces.
- D. Germany implemented unrestricted submarine warfare without any coherent strategic reasoning, acting purely out of desperation and a desire to demonstrate continued military capability after years of grueling stalemate on the Western Front.

KEY: A · DOK 3 · US.26

Why the key is right: Germany's strategic reasoning was internally coherent but contained a fatal flaw. Germany gambled that unrestricted submarine warfare could strangle British supply lines and force Britain out of the war before the United States could mobilize and deploy forces in significant numbers — essentially a race against time. German military planners calculated (correctly) that the U.S. would declare war in response, but believed (incorrectly) that they could deliver a knockout blow to Britain before American forces arrived in decisive numbers. The fatal flaw was underestimating American mobilization speed and overestimating the time it would take for U.S. forces to affect the battlefield. Options B and C misidentify the strategic logic; Option D is factually incorrect.